RIGHTSIZE. RIGHT SUPPORT.
RIGHT for STUDENTS.

Rightsizing Phase 1:
Methods and After-Action Review

Phase 1 of Portland Public Schools' Rightsizing efforts took place from April to June of 2026. This period of planning and engagement centered on "Listening and Learning." The purpose of engagement and data collection in Phase 1 was to generally hear feedback and concerns from the community, as well as identify guiding principles to shape the updated Student Assignment Policy and guide the development of rightsizing scenarios. To do this, the Office of School Modernization, the Office of Family and Community Engagement, and the Research, Assessment, and Accountability department worked together to build community engagement events that would systematically collect data from and about engagement participants.

Engagement and Data Collection

Throughout April 2026, the Family and Community Engagement (FACE) department, the Office of School Planning Modernization, and the Office of Strategic Project Management hosted a series of engagement sessions to gather feedback on the school rightsizing process. This effort included six community sessions, a dedicated student advisory session, and meetings with school staff. Additionally, two focus groups were held to conduct an equity audit of the Southeast Guiding Coalition, a rightsizing effort that took place from 2020 to 2024. Insights from this equity audit helped to drive decision-making in the current iteration of rightsizing. Table 1 lists the engagement sessions that took place during Phase 1.

Table 1:

Engagement sessions held as part of Phase 1 of Rightsizing

Engagement	Location	Date	Time	Stakeholder
Southeast Guiding Coalition Focus Group	Virtual	April 8	6:00pm	Southeast Guiding Coalition Community
Southeast Guiding Coalition Focus Group	Kellogg	April 11	10:00am	Southeast Guiding Coalition Community
PPS Board of Education Public Engagement Session	Kellogg	April 11	2:00pm	ALL
PPS Board of Education Public Engagement Session	Virtual	April 20	6:00pm	ALL
PPS Board of Education Public Engagement Session	Ida B. Wells	April 22	6:00pm	ALL
PPS Board of Education Public Engagement Session	Benson	April 25	2:00pm	ALL
PPS Board of Education Public Engagement Session	Roosevelt	April 27	6:00pm	ALL
Student Voice Advisory Council	Virtual	April 9	4:45pm	Middle School Student
Village Table	Faubion	April 15	6:00pm	Parents/Families
Administrative Assistants	Virtual	April 23	10:00am	Administrative Assistants (Front Office)

Throughout this time, PPS collected community feedback through a variety of ways: notetaking during community listening sessions, a virtual Slido poll, a FACE-department generated feedback form, and the planning of culturally specific outreach. Each form of data collected will be described in greater depth below.

Slido Polls

During engagement sessions, participants utilized the digital polling tool Slido to submit responses. While the poll itself was in English, there were paper copies of the questions available in Simplified Chinese, Somali, Spanish, Russian, and Vietnamese upon request. After the conclusion of the Board listening sessions, the same Slido poll was sent out to all district families regardless of whether they attended a listening session. Altogether, approximately 900 stakeholders responded to this poll. The questions included in the Slido were adapted from the 2015 Oregon Kitchen Table survey, as well as the Student Assignment Policy. See Appendix A to view the questions asked in the Slido poll.

While the engagement reached a broad cross-section of the district, the responses were disproportionately representative of white families (76-80% across most sessions) and families of students identified as Talented and Gifted (TAG). The majority of participants were connected to K-5 school communities, and nearly a third had students enrolled in focus option programs. See the Slido and Listening Session Synthesis Memo for more information.

When asked to rank the six factors of the PPS Student Assignment Policy, a clear system-wide preference emerged for compact boundaries, "right pathways" (ensuring predictable transitions from elementary to middle and high school), and program balance. However, individual sessions revealed localized deviations from this trend. For instance, families at the Village Table session—representing more marginalized communities—placed a much higher priority on student body demographics and safer routes to school. In contrast, families at Ida B. Wells and Benson prioritized community and enrollment stability, viewing the preservation of established neighborhood hubs as essential to preventing enrollment loss to private institutions.

Participants also identified several key factors as essential for a positive school environment, led by a wide variety of learning opportunities and access to specialized services for all student needs. While a warm and welcoming atmosphere was a universal priority, the value placed on diversity varied by session. Participants at Village Table, Kellogg, and Roosevelt explicitly prioritized "learning alongside students from different backgrounds," whereas other sessions focused more on geographic proximity and the ability of neighborhood children to attend the same school. This highlights a tension between the desire for integrated, diverse learning environments and the practical convenience of neighborhood-based schooling.

FACE Department Feedback Form

In addition to the Slido poll, the FACE Department internally developed a feedback form and used it to develop an informational flier summarizing what had been heard. A total of 227 people responded to this form. This drew from a different data source than the Slido or Slido Summary Memos.

Culturally Specific Outreach

At the conclusion of Phase 1, the demographic data from the Slido polls showed that Black and Native voices were underrepresented in the feedback PPS has received. In response, the FACE Department planned two culturally specific engagement events: one for Native families (June 15) and one for Black families (June 11).

SEGC Equity Audit. Portland Public Schools implemented the Enrollment and Program Balancing initiative, often called the Southeast Guiding Coalition or SEGC, as part of a broader district effort to address enrollment imbalances, program access, and related equity concerns across Southeast Portland schools between 2020 and 2024. In 2026, PPS partnered with Dr. Terrance Green to evaluate the equity impact of SEGC to better understand how SEGC-related changes were experienced by students, families, principals, educators, and staff, in schools that experienced boundary changes, program relocations, enrollment shifts, and other related transitions. Additionally, Dr. Green's team analyzed patterns in student outcomes in these impacted schools before and after SEGC implementation, while recognizing that these outcomes are shaped by multiple factors and should not be interpreted as solely caused by SEGC. To that end, this team implemented surveys that received over 1200 responses, as well as conducted 50 focus groups and 10 interviews with families and staff impacted by SEGC.

How Data Informed Policy

Feedback from the Slido polls was synthesized after each engagement session and summaries were posted on the Rightsizing website. A summary memo considering feedback from across sessions was also written and posted. Additionally, this information was used to update the Student Assignment Policy and identify the guiding principles for Phase 2 of Rightsizing.

Lessons Learned and Next Steps for Phase 2

Through the engagement and data collection process in Phase 1, we learned several lessons that will improve data collection and representation for Phase 2 of the Rightsizing process.

Attendees at the engagement sessions (and subsequently, respondents to the Slido informational poll) were majority white and parents of elementary-aged students. These voices were disproportionately represented when compared with the district's overall demographics. To address this, we will identify sampling thresholds for stakeholders in Phase 2 which will help us to know when we have heard from a representative sample of district stakeholders. To accompany these goals, we will also identify sampling and outreach strategies to increase underrepresented voices, as well as establish protocols to supplement survey data collection with focus groups and other forms of data collection when needed.

Additionally, we intend to align data sources more closely in Phase 2. Instead of operating with multiple polls and forms, we hope to establish shared data collection platforms used by all PPS stakeholders to collect standardized data regardless of the session attended. This way, we can more easily synthesize feedback we hear from various community stakeholders.

Appendix A:

Slido Poll Questions

1) What school community or communities are you connected with?

2) I have students in the following grade ranges: (select all that apply)
   a) Pre-K
   b) K-5
   c) 6-9
   d) 9-12
   e) Not in school yet
   f) Out of school (K12)

3) How does your student (s) identify racially? (select all that apply)
   a) African American/Black
   b) American Indian/Alaska Native
   c) Asian
   d) Hispanic/Latino/Latinx
   e) Middle Eastern/North African
   f) Pacific Islander
   g) White
   h) Multiple Racial Identities
   i) I prefer not to answer

4) What programs or services have your students participated in:
   a) Dual language immersion
   b) Special education
   c) Talented and Gifted
   d) Multilingual learners
   e) 504
   f) Focus option school or program such as the arts or STEM

5) In the past five years, has your family experienced a school transition? (select all)
   a) Boundary change
   b) Grade level of their school changed
   c) The program they were attending moved
   d) Attended a different school that was a swing space while their school was modernized
   e) Attended a different school because of storm damage
   f) Opening of a school
   g) None of the above
   h) Not sure

6) What has helped you/your student feel connected as they move from one school to the next?

7) In the past five years, has your family experienced a school transition that you initiated? Why?

8) Our PPS Student Assignment Policy asks us to consider the following six factors. Please select **the three most important** factors to consider during program and enrollment balancing across our system.

1. Right Pathways: A feeder pattern that allows as many students as possible to continue together from one school level to the next
2. Right Mix of Students: Student body demographics
3. Right Boundaries: Compact boundaries that promote safer routes to schools and a sense of community as well as recognize and address natural and human-made barriers
4. Right use of Space: Optimal use of existing facilities
5. Right Balance: Program and enrollment stability in the surrounding schools
6. Right Impact: Limiting the impact of boundary changes to the smallest number of students possible

9) In 2015, we asked families what they hoped PPS would be like in 2025. Now, select the **top four factors** that you think make a positive school environment:

1. Learning alongside children from different backgrounds
2. Opportunities for parent involvement
3. Access to dual language immersion
4. A warm and welcoming school environment
5. Wide variety of learning opportunities including access to music, art, library, and physical education
6. Access to after-school programs
7. Ability of children who live close together to attend the same school
8. Access to learning in the student's preferred language
9. Ability of children to walk or bike safely to school
10. Access to services that meet every student's learning needs (including special education, English as a second language, talented and gifted program)
11. Lower likelihood of enrolling in a multi-grade class

10) How important is it that students and families have access to a variety of learning environments close to where they live? (e.g. dual language immersion programs, neighborhood schools, focus programs or schools)

- Not Important (minimal relevance)
- Somewhat Important (nice to have but not critical)
- Important (should be prioritized when possible)
- Essential (critical to success)

11) What should leaders understand about your community before making decisions like this?

12) What else should we think about during this process?